hopes for deepening trade with China and for Chinese investment in India, yet Indians do not wish to promote a political or economic bloc with *de facto* Chinese leadership. Each move toward closer economic integration with China thus tends to be balanced by conscious and public efforts to demonstrate that India has other friends in Asia and the world. In the words of senior think tank scholar Sanjaya Baru, India is eager to cooperate with China, so long as the latter "rejects an imperialist view of history and believes in the creation of a multipolar world."[214]

Apprehensions over cooperation with China have emerged from multiple quarters in India. Security experts express concerns that participation in multilateral financial institutions with the Chinese may be dangerous for India and expect that the India-China rivalry will continue even as the NDB and CRA begin operations.[215] Former Foreign Secretary Shyam Saran, for example, warmly endorsed the NDB, but he worried about Indian dependence on China, diplomatically concluding that "in some cases our interests are closer to United States and Europe, while in some we are closer to China."[216] Even the Mumbai business and financial community, among the strongest promoters of BRICS in India, worries about Chinese authoritarianism. Thus, the rapporteur on a recent "BRICS Studies" meeting in China highlighted Indian concerns that "if China wants to partner with BRICS and other emerging economies in articulating a new development theology, it will have to address internal social infirmities such as restrictive human rights, the bar on freedom of speech, and lax safety standards at its industrial complexes."[217]

Strategic balancing between China and the West is key to India's survival. Consequently, India's desire to see the Western powers be less hegemonic in international money and financial markets does not amount to support for increasing Chinese dominance. On the one hand, many Indians view increased international use of the RMB as a positive step toward redistribution of power to the south. Another Gateway House–affiliated commentator welcomed the inclusion of the RMB in the IMF's virtual currency, the SDR, framing the event as confirming "the IMF intent to bring emerging markets into operational issues and decisions related to the global monetary system," and optimistically concluding that "the inclusion of the RMB is likely just the first step toward bringing other emerging market currencies into the SDR."[218]